

REDCOAT UNIFORM

This is the uniform of the British light infantry (the "light bobs") at the time of the Napoleonic Wars. Like the line infantry, they wore bright red jackets, which made sense when battles were fought on a field that would be heavily obscured by gunpowder smoke, making identification of friend or foe difficult. Concealment was not considered desirable, even for light troops who might be employed as skirmishers. The "stovepipe" shako was adopted as British infantry headgear in 1801-02.

Shako
The cylindrical or "stovepipe" shako was made of felt with a leather peak. The bugle-horn badge and green plume were symbols of light infantry.

Buttonless collar

Right epaulette buttons over haversack shoulder strap

Left epaulette buttons over cartridge box shoulder strap

Green plume of light infantry

Light infantry bugle-horn badge

Leather peak

> "I DON'T KNOW WHAT EFFECT THESE MEN WILL HAVE ON THE ENEMY, BUT BY GOD, THEY TERRIFY ME."
>
> **DUKE OF WELLINGTON**, PENINSULAR WAR, 1809

Red became the standard colour for infantry during the English Civil War

Lace rectangles based on hussar jacket design

Lace colours specific to 68th Light Infantry

Tunic
Private soldiers wore a single-breasted brick-red tunic. The green facings (collar, cuffs, and shoulder straps), plus the shape, colour, and spacing of the lace, are all light infantry features. Officers' tunics were double-breasted and of a brighter red.

White wool inner lining

Regimental number on pewter tunic buttons

Shoulder straps crossed at chest

Light infantry shoulder wings